

Eugene Jang

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Academic Positions

Assistant Professor 2025–pres.
 School of Communication, Rochester Institute of Technology

Education

University of Southern California 2020–2025
 Annenberg School for Communication and Journalism
 Ph.D. in Communication

Dissertation: Online social support discourse structure and social media affordances: A comparative analysis of Twitter and Reddit's Long COVID communities

Committee: Drs. Lindsay Young (Co-chair), Robin Stevens (Co-chair), Jennifer A. Petersen

Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea 2017–2019
 M.A. in Communication

Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea 2011–2016
 B.A. in Communication, *summa cum laude*

Research Interests

health communication, social/digital media, artificial intelligence (AI), science and technology studies (STS), social equity, social network analysis, computational methods

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Jang, E., Nan, Y., Chang, H., & Young, L. E. (2026). Disentangling the network structure of online social support: A multilayer network analysis of a Twitter Long COVID community. *Health Communication*, 1–12. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2026.2672056>

Jang, E. (2025). When faulty AI falls into the wrong hands: The risks of erroneous AI-driven healthcare decisions. *International Journal of Communication*, 19, 1859–1865. <https://ijoc.org/index.php/ijoc/article/view/23994/4992>

Yang, A., Jieun, S., Kim, H. M., Zhou, A., Liu, W., Huang-Isherwood, K. M., **Jang, E.**, Sun, J., Lee, E., Yafei, Z., & Chuqin, D. (2023). Who says what in which networks: What influences social media users' emotional reactions to the COVID-19 vaccine infodemic? *Social Science Computer Review*, 41(6), 1986–2009. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393221128940>

Young, L. E., Nan, Y., **Jang, E.**, & Stevens, R. (2023). Digital epidemiological approaches in HIV research: A scoping methodological review. *Current HIV/AIDS Reports*, 20, 470–480. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11904-023-00673-x>

Jang, E., Baik, J. S., & Fischer, K. (2023). Contact tracing apps as boundary objects of pandemic governance: The state-by-state approach to contain the spread of COVID-19 in the US. *International Journal of Communication*, 17, 1737–1758. <https://ijoc.org/index.php/ijoc/article/view/19621>

Baik, J. S., & **Jang, E.** (2022). Where horizontal and vertical surveillances meet: Sense-making of US COVID-19 contact tracing apps during a health crisis. *Mobile Media & Communication*, 10(3), 468–486. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20501579221078674>

Jang, E., Park, S., Lee, J., & Hong, S. (2019). Beautiful and masculine: Male make-up YouTubers and heteronormativity in South Korea. *The Journal of Popular Culture*, 52(3), 678–702. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jpcu.12803>

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

Guo, S., He, Z., Rao, A., **Jang, E.**, Nan, Y., Morstatter, F., Brantingham, J., & Lerman, K. (2023). Measuring online emotional reactions to events. In *Proceedings of the 2023 IEEE/ACM International Conference on Advances in Social Networks Analysis and Mining* (pp. 315–319). <https://doi.org/10.1145/3625007.3627477>

Felkner, V., Chang, H., **Jang, E.**, & May, J. (2023). WinoQueer: A community-in-the-loop benchmark for anti-LGBTQ+ bias in large language models. In A. Rogers, J. Boyd-Graber, & N. Okazaki (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics* (pp. 9126–9140). <https://aclanthology.org/2023.acl-long.507>

Whitepapers

Yang, Y., Baik, J. S., Ahn, S. & **Jang, E.** (2020). Tracing digital contact tracing: Surveillance technology and privacy rights during COVID-19 in China, South Korea, and the United States. <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.3743491>

Manuscripts Under Review/In Preparation

Jang, E., Huang, H. V., Wang, Y., Nan, Y., Arnold, L. J., Xie, L., Persaud, C. J., & Stevens, R. (Under Review). Online discourse on substance use and sex among young Black and Hispanic men (modified title).

Jang, E. (Under Review). Social media affordances and social support within online health communities (modified title).

Repetto, A., **Jang, E.**, Kinzer, H., & Wang, M. (Under Review). Narratives around Health Disparity Among Racial Minority Groups on Twitter (modified title).

Young, L. E., **Jang, E.**, Lee, E., Baird, A., Nan, Y., & Tang, J. L. (Under Review). Digital Grassroots Witnessing of the Epidemic of Fatal Violence Against Black Transgender People (modified title).

Kim, D., Huang-Isherwood, K. M., Li, Y., **Jang, E.**, & Bisberg, A. (Under Review). A cross-cultural comparison of gaming behaviors (modified title).

Jang, E. (In Preparation). A cross-platform analysis of social support discourse in Long COVID communities.

Jang, E., Huang-Isherwood, K. M., Kim, S. S., Jung, S., & Curry, M. (In Preparation). Cultural values, social dynamics, and well-being in online gaming.

Arnold, L., Xie, L., **Jang, E.**, Nan, Y., Persaud, C., & Stevens, R. (In Preparation). “If there is life, there is hope”: Communicating motivations and concerns among Black and Latino men navigating economic and masculinity pressures.

Selected Conference Presentations

Jang, E. (presenter) (2026, June). Social Media Affordances and Online Social Support in the Long COVID Communities on Twitter/X and Reddit. Communication and Technology Division at

- the 76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA). Cape Town, South Africa.
- Jang, E.** (presenter), Nan, Y., Chang, H., & Young, L. E. (2024, November). Disentangling the Network Structure of Online Social Support: A Multilayer Network Analysis of the Twitter Long COVID Community. Health Communication Division at the 108th Annual Convention of the National Communication Association (NCA). New Orleans, LA.
- Jang, E.** (presenter), Kinzer, H., Repetto, A., & Wang, M. (2024, July). Social Media Agendas and Research Agendas around Racial/Ethnic Health Disparities. The 10th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²). Philadelphia, PA.
- Jang, E.** (presenter), Nan, Y., Wang, Y., Persaud, C. J., Arnold, L. J., Xie, L., Fischer, K., & Stevens, R. (2024, April). Comparing Offline Sexual Behavior to Online Discourse on Sex and Substance Use of Young Black and Hispanic Men. The 18th Biennial Kentucky Conference on Health Communication (KCHC). Lexington, KY.
- Huang-Isherwood, K. M., **Jang, E.** (presenter), Kim, S. S., Jung, S., & Drivas, M. (2023, May). Birds of a Feather Play Together: Individualism, Player Homophily, and Well-Being in a Massively Multiplayer Online Mobile Game. Game Studies Division at the 73rd Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA). Toronto, Canada. *Awarded Top Student Paper*
- Jang, E.** (presenter), Nan, Y., & Young, L. E. (2022, November). Hashtags as Discursive Agents: An analysis of hashtag community structure and brokerage in the Twitter Black Trans Lives Matter movement. Gay, Lesbian, Bisexual, Transgender, and Queer Communication Studies Division at the 108th Annual Convention of the National Communication Association (NCA). New Orleans, LA.
- Jang, E.** (presenter), Bae, I. & Lee, E. (2022, May). Good Samaritans, Bad Samaritans: How News Coverages of Immigrants' Act Affect Readers' Attitude Toward Them. Mass Communication Division at the 72nd Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA). Paris, France.
- Baik, J. S., & **Jang, E.** (presenter) (2022, May). Where horizontal and vertical surveillances meet: Sense-making of US COVID-19 contact tracing apps during a health crisis. Mobile Communication Interest Group at the 72nd Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA). Paris, France.
- Jang, E.** (presenter), Fischer, K., & Baik, J.S. (2021, November). Between Public Health and Privacy: A Critical Examination of Statewide Contact Tracing Apps as Boundary Objects of Pandemic Governance. Association for the Rhetoric of Science, Technology, and Medicine (ARSTM) Division at the 107th Annual Convention of the National Communication Association (NCA). Seattle, WA. *Presented at the ARSTM Top Paper Panel*
- Jang, E.** (presenter) (2018, August). Construction of "Pretty Boy" Masculinity in Korean Buddy Films. Preconference for the 12th Association for Cultural Studies: Crossroads in Cultural Studies. Shanghai, China.

Honors and Awards

Herbert S. Dordick Dissertation Award , International Communication Association (ICA)	2026
Doctoral Study Abroad Fellowship , Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies (\$65,000)	2020–2025
Graduate School Endowed Fellowship , University of Southern California (\$40,500)	2024–2025
Top Paper Award	
Game Studies Division, National Communication Association (NCA)	2023
Association for the Rhetoric of Science, Technology, and Medicine Division,	2021
National Communication Association (NCA)	

Top Student Paper Award

2023

Game Studies Division, International Communication Association (ICA)

Research Grants ($\geq$ \$1000)

RIT Faculty Development Grant (\$3,300)	2026
RIT Seed Funding Award (\$10,000)	2026
RIT Faculty Research Fund (\$1,500)	2025
Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies Research Award (\$1,500)	2025
USC Annenberg Dissertation Research Funds (\$3,000)	2024
USC Annenberg Graduate Fellows Journal Article Workshop Award (\$1,000)	2024
USC Annenberg Summer Research Grant (\$2,000)	2023
USC Annenberg Graduate Fellowship Research & Creative Project Symposium (\$2,600)	2022–2024
USC Graduate Student Government Professional Development Fund (\$1,500)	2022–2024
USC Annenberg Summer Education Grant (\$2,000)	2022
USC Graduate School Research/Travel Award (\$1,000)	2022
USC Media as Socio-Technical Systems (MASTS) Honorarium (\$1,000)	2020

Teaching Experience

Assistant Professor, Rochester Institute of Technology	2025–2026
• COMM 717 Artificial Intelligence & Communication • COMM 605 Social Media Analytics and Research • COMM 356 Critical Practice in Social Media • COMM 343 Technology-Mediated Communication	
Instructor of Record, University of Southern California	2024
• COMM 204 Public Speaking	
Teaching Assistant (Discussion Section), University of Southern California	2023
• COMM 200 Communication and Social Sciences (Fall 2023)	
Teaching Assistant, University of Southern California	2021
• COMM 309 Communication and Technology (Fall 2021)	
Teaching Assistant, Big Data Institute, Seoul National University	2019
• Introductory Course on Python and MySQL	
Teaching Assistant, Seoul National University	2017–2018
• 211.706 Studies in Visual Communication (Fall 2018) • 211.669 Cultural Studies and Visual Methods (Spring 2018) • 200.113A Understanding Communication (Spring 2018) • M1312.001200 Media and Storytelling (Fall 2017)	

Guest Lectures

<i>Societal Impacts of Artificial Intelligence Systems</i>	Feb 19, 2026
Business and Public Policy (by Prof. Qing Miao), Rochester Institute of Technology	
<i>Computational Social Network Analysis in Games</i>	Feb 5, 2024

Video Games: Business, Science and Culture (by Prof. Dmitri Williams), University of Southern California

Research Experience

- Research Assistant – PI: Dr. Lindsay Young 2022–2023
- Conducted content analysis of tweets and network analysis on Twitter hashtag co-occurrence patterns for the Black Trans Lives Matter (BTLM) project
- Research Assistant – USC Annenberg Research Network on International Communication 2022
(Co-PIs: Dr. François Bar & Dr. Hernan Galperin)
- Drafted policy briefs on US broadband consumer subsidy programs, including California Lifeline
- Research Assistant – SNU Big Data Studies Lab (PI: Dr. Javier Cha) 2020
- Researched big data, data centers, and surveillance
 - Coordinated lab meetings and managed general administrative tasks
- Research Assistant – PI: Dr. Eun-ju Lee 2019–2020
- Project Titles: *When Rewards Become Punishment: Motivated Misattribution of Outgroup Member's Good Deeds*; *From Selective Exposure to Opinion Polarization*
 - Designed experimental stimuli and questionnaires; ran statistical analyses using SPSS

Research Affiliations

- Health and Equity Media Collaborative, University of Southern California 2023–2025
PI: Dr. Robin Stevens
- Annenberg Game Group, University of Southern California 2021–2025
PI: Dr. Dmitri Williams
- Annenberg Networks Network (ANN), University of Southern California 2020–2025
Co-Directors: Dr. Lindsay Young, Dr. Aimei Yang, and Dr. Marlon Twyman
- Media as Socio-Technical Systems (MASTS), University of Southern California 2020–2025
Co-Directors: Dr. Mike Ananny, Dr. Colin McClay

Service

- Rochester Institute of Technology, Graduate Curriculum Committee Member (2026–present)
- Peer Reviewer: *International Journal of Communication*, *Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA)*, *National Communication Association Annual Convention (NCA)*, *The International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²)*

Professional Membership

- International Communication Association (ICA) 2020–
Health Communication, Communication & Technology, Computational Methods
- National Communication Association (NCA) 2020–
Health Communication, Human Communication & Technology, Mass Communication
- Korean American Communication Association (KACA) 2023–

Korean-American Scientists and Engineers Association (KSEA)

2025–

Special Training

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, University of Pennsylvania (2 weeks) 2023

Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR) Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research (1 month) 2022

Courses: Network Analysis II, Regression Analysis II

Data Science Boot Camp, Big Data Institute, Seoul National University (1 month) 2019

Courses: Advanced Python for Data Science, Introduction to Machine Learning and Deep Learning

Introduction to Python and MySQL, Big Data Institute, Seoul National University (4 months) 2019

Summer Program in Methods of Social Science Research, Korea Social Science Data Archive 2018

Courses: Intermediate Statistics, Text Analysis with R (2 weeks)

Languages/Skills

Language English (Advanced), Korean (Native)

Tools/Software R, Python, UCINET, SPSS, NVivo, LIWC

Computer Skills Premiere and Photoshop, Certified Microsoft Office Specialist 2007 Master